The user manual says
Central contact points (e.g. tricurse.com/contact) report availability without being throttled by client-tier quotas.
Is the quota tracked separately for the clients and the main contact point?

Yes, the quotas and their tracking are differentiated between individual clients and the central contact point.

Here is how the architecture handles quotas and availability tracking:

---

1. Dual-Tier Quota Model: Inside vs. Outside

The system defines two separate quota categories in `site_settings`:

- **Inside Quota (`rate_limit_inside_per_day`, default: `100` msgs/day):** Applied to communications between local server group members, subdomains, and loopback peers identified via `/etc/hosts`. Local client-to-client correspondence and client-to-main communication use this higher inside threshold.
- **Outside Quota (`rate_limit_outside_per_day`, default: `10` msgs/day):** Applied to untrusted, external remote domains across the internet.

---

2. How the Tracking Operates

A. Shared Database & Sender-Based Window

All clients and the main contact point on a server share the same central database (contact.sqlite). Rate limiting is **sender-based**, calculated against a rolling 24-hour window:

```
SELECT COUNT(*) FROM incoming_messages
WHERE sender_host = ? AND is_sent_copy = 0
  AND received_at >= datetime('now', '-24 hours')
```

B. Client-Tier Subdomains

For ordinary client subdomains (e.g. `novy.addr.bar` and `karo.addr.bar`):

- Client accounts share the server's incoming client-tier allowance for a given external sender. If a remote website dispatches a letter to `novy.addr.bar`, the remaining daily quota from that sender decreases across the client accounts on that server.

C. Local Destination Probing

When checking internal availability via check_destination_availability(), the query scopes the count to the specific recipient:

```
SELECT COUNT(*) FROM incoming_messages
WHERE sender_host = ? AND target_domain = ?
  AND is_sent_copy = 0 AND received_at >= datetime('now', '-24 hours')
```

This ensures messages intended for a client account do not consume the quota bucket of another destination when probed internally.

---

3. Why the Main Contact Point is Not Throttled by Client-Tier Quotas

- **Role Distinction (`server_role = 'main'` vs. `'client'`):** The main contact point acts as the primary contact point and transmitter for the entire server group. It is designed to accept inbound broadcast communications, directory inquiries, and group correspondence without being restricted by individual client subdomain constraints.
- **Domain-Scoped Settings (`<domain>::setting_key`):** The settings engine in db.php supports per-domain overrides in `site_settings`. The administrator can assign independent rate limits (or disable rate limiting entirely) for the main domain (e.g. `hotletter.neolamia.com::rate_limit_outside_per_day` or `rate_limiting_enabled = '0'`) without altering the limits enforced on client subdomains.

If an individual client’s incoming letter limit for an external domain is reached, can the Main Contact Point still receive messages that will be accessible for them in Group Letters?

Yes. If an individual client’s incoming direct letter limit for an external domain is reached, the **Main Contact Point** (Central Transmitter) can still receive messages from that external domain, and those letters **will be accessible to that client in their Group Letters tab.**

Here is how the architecture handles this:

---

1. Direct Client Letters vs. Central Transmitter Broadcasts

- **Private Client Correspondence (`tab=client`):** When an external website addresses an individual client directly (e.g. `novy.addr.bar`), the correspondence is strictly private. It is delivered only to that client's inbox and consumes the client's direct incoming allowance for that external sender.
- **Transmitter Broadcasts (`tab=group`):** When an external sender writes to the **Main Contact Point** (the Central Transmitter, e.g. `tricurse.com/contact`), the letter functions as a server-wide communication. Because client accounts are registered in `main_subscriptions` to the main website, all letters arriving at the Main Contact Point are automatically broadcast to all member clients.

---

2. Tab Routing: Group Letters

In db.php:

- Letters arriving at the Main Contact Point are flagged as `Transmitter Broadcast` and categorized as `is_server_group_letter = true`.
- Rather than entering any single client's private `Client Letters` queue, they route directly to the **Group Letters** tab (`tab=group`) for all subscribed clients.
- An individual client's private client-tier quota applies to direct 1-to-1 client correspondence, not to incoming group broadcasts received by the Central Transmitter.

---

3. Summary of the Workflow

Letter Path	Destination Evaluated	Quota Bucket Used	Inbox Tab Where It Appears
External $ \rightarrow$ Individual Client	Client domain	Direct client quota	**Client Letters** (Private to client)

Letter Path	Destination Evaluated	Quota Bucket Used	Inbox Tab Where It Appears
External $ \rightarrow$ Main Contact Point	Main contact point	Main contact point quota	**Group Letters** (Visible to all clients)

Even if an external sender can no longer send direct private letters to an individual client due to a daily limit, sending to the **Main Contact Point** will deliver the message to the server, where the client can read it under **Group Letters**.